

KF Reading Guide for HPKP¹

Chapters 1 & 2: *Honor and Shame*

Introduction: *Cultural Awareness & Reading Scripture*

1. How does the potential for misunderstanding increase? (17.1)

2. What is “culture”? (17.2–18.1)

3. The New Testament authors were working toward redefining what deep-rooted values? (18.2)

4. To what is there a tendency to turn a blind eye when investigating the context of the early church? (19, footnote 4)

5. In short, what does this volume chiefly seek to do? (21.2)

Chapter One: Honor & Shame

1. On what values was the culture of the first century world built? (23.1)

2. What phrases does Isocrates repeatedly use as sanctions for behavior? (24.2)

3. What two aspects of honor, the marks of a valuable person, does Dr. deSilva identify? (25.2)
 - A.
 - B.

4. What does shame first signify? (25.3)
5. What is the positive character trait of shame? (25.3)
6. What move has greatly tempered the dynamics of honor and shame in our culture? (26.2)
7. In the first-century Greco-Roman world, what words are used when speaking of honor? (27.3–28.1)
8. In what two ways can honor come to someone? (28.2-3)
 - A.
 - B.
9. What can diminish honor? (31.1)
10. What does *blaspheme* mean? (32, footnote 9)
11. What did the desire to be honored ensure? (35.2)
12. What virtue was held in extremely high regard? (35.3)
13. Because civic improvement depended on the wealthy, what other virtue was highly honored? (35.3)

14. What became the dominant means of enforcing values that are not actually legislated? (36.1)
15. What two strategies are used to secure allegiance and defuse pressure from outsiders? (40.1-2)
 - A.
 - B.
16. The New Testament writings develop a distinctly Christian definition of what? (42.2)

Chapter Two: Honor and Shame in the New Testament

1. What did the values and message of early Christians differ from and even contradict? (43.1)
2. To what did the authors of the New Testament devote much of their attention? (43.1)
3. What were the neighbors of Christians trying to do through persecution? (45.3)
4. How do non-believers who are near you try to draw you back into conformity with their values and requirements?
5. Why did Christians remove themselves from much of the public life of their city? (47.2)

6. Do you find that you cannot participate in a social life with those around you? Why?
7. What is more than enough to motivate unofficial persecution? (47.2)
8. In response to Greco-Roman society's attempts to dissuade Christians from continuing in their "deviant way of life", what two critical issues do New Testament authors address? (50.2)
 - A.
 - B.
9. How is Jesus presented by the evangelists? (51.2)
10. In what two ways was Jesus' death a noble death? (52.2–53.1)
 - A.
 - B.
11. What does the case of Jesus demonstrate? (53.3)
12. For the Christian, who constitutes the new "court of reputation"? (55.2-3)

13. What makes God's estimation of the individual of first importance to believers? (56.1)
14. Of what do New Testament authors frequently remind the churches? (56.3)
15. Who is the most visible and most available reflection of God's estimation of someone? (59.2)
16. What specific ethos does the author of Hebrews invoke? (59.6–60.1)
17. What did hospitality do for the early church? (60.1)
18. What does the hospitality of others do for you?
19. Why do the authors urge the hearers to reach out to those most acutely targeted by society? (60.1)
20. What do New Testament authors stress when explaining why the approval or disapproval of outsiders should not matter to Christians? (62.1)
21. Why do you think the world's opinion of you should not matter?

22. What are two other understandings of the English word “blessed”? (67.3)
23. What qualities did competing athletes need? (69.2)
24. Advice given to believers in First Peter and Titus can be seen as serving what goal? (72.1)
25. What fine line does the Christian group keep walking? (73.1)
26. What is removed when honor is not gained through inheritance or performance? (75, footnote 44)
27. Toward what are members encouraged to channel their ambition for honor? (80.2)
28. What two considerations regarding honor are inseparably linked? (83.2)
- A.
- B.
29. How can a cultural value of honor increase our self-respect and our validation and give us our worth? (86.2)

30. Let's consider the mechanisms by which we can encourage each other to stay on course in the "race set before us". (90.3)

- A. What do we need to break through?
- B. What should we encourage people to talk about?
- C. What should we elevate?
- D. What do we need to increase?

31. How can we improve the mission of the church? (92.3–93.1)

- A.
- B.

32. There is an honor/shame culture in Karis Fellowships. How would you describe it?

¹ This reading guide refers to the 2000 edition of *Honor, Patronage, Kinship & Purity* by David A. deSilva, published by Inter Varsity Press, Downers Grove, Illinois.